Next, we'll add volume and bug count to our estimates to show how you can better identify how your team is doing.

3.2.4. Tip 4: Clearly define when tasks are done

Done means a task is complete. Despite the seemingly simple definition, *done* can be a tough thing for the business and the agile team to figure out and agree on. Because the data in your PTS associates time with tasks, the criteria for which tasks are complete are key because they determine when to put an end time on a task. Often, done means that the task in question is ready to deploy to your consumers. If you group lots of changes into deployments and have a separate process for delivering code, then measuring the time it takes to get ready for a deployment cycle makes sense. If you move to a model where you're continuously deploying changes to your consumers, it's better to categorize tasks as done after they've been deployed. Whatever your deployment methodologies are, here are some things to consider when defining done for your team's tasks:

- Whatever was originally asked for is working.
- Automated tests exist for whatever you built.
- All tests across the system you're developing against pass.
- A certain number of consumers are using the change.
- You are measuring the business value of the change.

Make sure you collaborate with your team and stakeholders on the definition of done for a task, and keep it simple to ensure that everyone understands it. Without a clear understanding and agreement, you're setting yourself up for unhappiness down the line when people don't agree when something is complete and you don't have data that you can trust.

Once a task is marked as done it becomes history, and any additional work should become a new task. It's often tempting to reopen tasks after they've been completed if the requirements change or a bug is found in a different development cycle. It's much better to leave the task as complete and open another task or bug fix. If you have a good agreement on what it means to be done and a task meets those criteria, there really is no good reason to make it undone.